



OFFICE OF THE
MAYOR

KEVIN JOHNSON
MAYOR

CITY OF SACRAMENTO
CALIFORNIA

September 25, 2009

Reverend [REDACTED] c/o
Oak Park United Methodist Church
3600 Broadway, P.O. Box 5133
Sacramento, CA 95817

Dear Reverend [REDACTED],

Thank you for sharing the PHIRS innovative approach to reducing the cost of health care by enabling community and faith-based organizations to provide efficient access to medical treatment facilities and information to assist a change in patient behavior. PHIRS, as developed by BESolutions, is a "bottoms up" support and compliment to many existing health care cost containment and delivery systems. However, PHIRS distinguishes itself by positioning local community and faith-based organizations to provide constituents timely and efficient access to healthcare providers, and tailored health education information to change patient behavior and improve long-term health outcomes.

I believe there is tremendous value in leveraging community and faith-based organizations into the national strategy to reduce cost and improve the health of America. Whether helping local community health centers, VA Medical Centers, faith-based community, senior centers or schools, I'm convinced that making health care delivery information available at the grass roots level will be a significant step forward in addressing the long term costs and health needs of underserved communities. Clearly, community clinics play an increasingly important and pivotal role in local health care delivery. PHIRS offers the opportunity to do even more with these clinics, by enhancing their ability to provide patient specific educational information to change patient behavior and achieve better long term health outcomes.

I strongly support the PHIRS approach because it demonstrates how local community and faith-based organizations can impact and help to reduce the long-term cost of healthcare. Most telling is the ability to direct persons with non-emergency medical issues to the most appropriate healthcare provider. By providing access to these primary care facilities, the treatment burden and high costs placed on an emergency room as a primary care facility will be significantly reduced. Clearly, the cost of primary care is substantially less than emergency room treatment costs, but the greater benefit will be the impact of primary care intervention on the long-term costs and more positive health

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outcomes. PHIRS directly addresses the challenge of providing underserved persons unaware of available treatment options practical access to healthcare delivery systems.